

ARACHIS ONLINE TRAINING

LOTION MAKING FORMULAS FOR ZIMBABWE

(Affordable Low-Cost Version + Premium Version)

These formulas are designed using ingredients commonly found in Zimbabwe from suppliers in Harare, Bulawayo, Gweru, and local chemical shops.

1. LOW-COST LOTION FORMULA

(Mass Market / Budget Lotion)

This formula is designed for:

- * low-income customers
- * school children
- * tuckshops
- * rural shops
- * daily-use family lotion

It is cheap to produce and still gives acceptable moisturizing performance.

LOW-COST LOTION FORMULA (10 LITRES)

Ingredient	Quantity	Purpose
Water	7 litres	Main base
Petroleum Jelly (Vaseline)	1 kg	Moisturizer
Light Liquid Paraffin / Baby Oil	500ml	Skin softener
Emulsifying Wax	300g	Helps oil and water mix
Stearic Acid	250g	Thickening
Glycerine	250ml	Moisture retention
Cetyl Alcohol (optional)	100g	Smooth feel
Preservative	20ml	Prevents bacteria
Fragrance	20–30ml	Smell
Colour	small amount	Appearance

PROCEDURE

STEP 1 — WATER PHASE

In a clean bucket:

Add:

- * water
- * glycerine

Heat to about 70°C.

STEP 2 — OIL PHASE

In another container add:

- * petroleum jelly
- * paraffin oil
- * emulsifying wax
- * stearic acid
- * cetyl alcohol

Heat until everything melts completely.

STEP 3 — MIXING

Slowly pour the oil phase into the water phase while stirring continuously.

Mix thoroughly for 10–15 minutes.

The lotion will begin thickening as it cools.

STEP 4 — FINAL ADDITIONS

When the mixture becomes warm (not hot):

Add:

- * fragrance
- * preservative
- * colour

Mix thoroughly.

EXPECTED RESULTS

- * White creamy lotion

- * Affordable production cost
- * Good for everyday use
- * Easy to package in:

- * 100ml
- * 200ml
- * 500ml bottles

ESTIMATED SELLING PRICE IN ZIMBABWE

Pack Size	Suggested Price
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100ml	\$0.50 – \$1
200ml	\$1 – \$1.50
500ml	\$2 – \$3

2. PREMIUM LOTION FORMULA

(Professional Cosmetic Lotion)

This version feels:

- * smoother
- * richer
- * more professional
- * better moisturizing
- * suitable for boutiques and pharmacies

PREMIUM LOTION FORMULA (10 LITRES)

Ingredient	Quantity	Purpose
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Distilled Water	6.5 litres	Base
Shea Butter	800g	Deep moisturizer
Cocoa Butter	500g	Skin nourishment
Sweet Almond Oil	500ml	Skin conditioning
Glycerine	400ml	Moisture
Emulsifying Wax	400g	Emulsifier
Stearic Acid	300g	Thickness
Cetyl Alcohol	200g	Smoothness
Vitamin E	50ml	Skin protection
Preservative	20ml	Shelf life
Premium Fragrance	30–50ml	Luxury scent
Niacinamide (optional)	100g	Brightening

| Colour | optional | Appearance |

PROCEDURE

The procedure is almost the same:

WATER PHASE

Heat:

- * water
- * glycerine

to 70°C.

OIL PHASE

Heat together:

- * shea butter
- * cocoa butter
- * almond oil
- * emulsifying wax
- * stearic acid
- * cetyl alcohol

until fully melted.

COMBINING

Slowly combine both phases while mixing continuously.

Use:

- * hand mixer
- * stick blender
- * lotion mixer

for smoother texture.

COOLING PHASE

When warm:

Add:

- * Vitamin E
- * preservative
- * fragrance
- * niacinamide

Mix thoroughly.

EXPECTED RESULTS

- * Smooth cosmetic texture
- * Rich skin feel
- * Better absorption
- * Professional appearance
- * Better customer perception

PACKAGING IDEAS

For premium appearance use:

- * white pump bottles
- * amber bottles
- * flip-top cosmetic bottles
- * branded stickers

Good packaging can double perceived value.

INGREDIENTS COMMONLY AVAILABLE IN ZIMBABWE

You can usually find these from:

- * chemical suppliers in Harare
- * cosmetic raw material suppliers
- * pharmacies
- * Avondale/Workington industrial areas
- * CodChem
- * Transchemical
- * Sai Mart
- * cosmetic ingredient resellers on WhatsApp and Facebook

Commonly available:

- ✓ Petroleum jelly
- ✓ Glycerine
- ✓ Paraffin oil
- ✓ Stearic acid
- ✓ Emulsifying wax
- ✓ Fragrance oils
- ✓ Preservatives

Premium ingredients like:

- * shea butter
 - * cocoa butter
 - * almond oil
- may cost more and are sometimes imported.

BUSINESS ADVICE

LOW-COST VERSION

Best for:

- * high volume sales
- * rural markets
- * tuckshops
- * school markets
- * flea markets

PREMIUM VERSION

Best for:

- * salons
- * boutiques
- * pharmacies
- * gift hampers
- * online branding

You can run BOTH:

- * low-cost for cashflow
- * premium for higher profit margins

That combination works very well in Zimbabwe.